

Workflow of the course and the exam

Team

- Course Coordinator: Mara Lein, course material, organisation & student support ([send email](#)).
- Instructor: Prof. Dr. Katarzyna Reluga, course lead ([send email](#)).

In case of questions, please read carefully this document (FAQ included).

If your question is not answered after reading the document, **please contact the course coordinator Mara Lein first.**

Workflow and organisation

- Flipped classroom course (06.-10.10.2025).
- Self-study component:
 - lecture videos/slides for each day to be studied independently before the start of the classes (e.g. before attending the in-person class on Day 1, you should watch all the videos and go through all the slides in the Day 1 folder).
 - Independent study time varies with your programming background; plan to spend **at least 2–3 hours per day** to be well prepared for programming sessions.
- In-person lab:
 - exercises to be solved together in person over five consecutive days, 16:00–19:00 in [Room 025](#) (Spandauer Str. 1). The sessions will also be available online via [Zoom](#) (Meeting ID: 686 6039 9025, Password: 816625).
 - lab work focuses on applying lecture and video content to hands-on programming problems.
- Exercises are to be solved independently — one can only learn programming by actually doing programming.
- All questions and comments related to the course content will be answered during the sessions.

Remark: Zoom sessions are only supplementary. The chat will be monitored, but please bear in mind that there is only one instructor leading the course. The main focus will be on supporting the in-person participants, so answers to Zoom questions may be delayed.

Take-home exam

- **Starts:** 31.10.2025
- **Submission:** via Moodle by 09.01.2026.

You will have more than two months to complete the exam. Please do not postpone working on it until the very last minute — solving it will require approximately 40–80 hours, depending on your prior coding experience. The exam will build directly on the course material, while also extending it in complexity and difficulty.

- **Format:** several programming tasks.

Each task will be a substantial programming exercise, based on the concepts taught in class but designed to go beyond them.

- **Individual work:** the exam must be solved independently.

Do not share or copy solutions. In past editions of the course, students who exchanged solutions failed the exam — both the student who copied and the one who shared.

- **Use of online resources:** resources such as StackOverflow, ChatGPT, Grok, DeepSeek, etc. may be used, but **must be properly acknowledged**.

If uncredited use is detected, and two students submit essentially identical solutions, both may be considered to have engaged in plagiarism and fail the exam.

- **Exam versions:** will differ (e.g. via different random seeds), but the level of difficulty will be the same for all participants.

Cancellation of registration

If you realise that you will not have enough time to complete the exam, or if unexpected circumstances prevent you from participating, please cancel your registration both in **AGNES** and by sending the instructor an email.

Deadline: 27.10.2025 (23:59).

This allows your slot to be offered to another student on the waiting list.

Frequently Asked Questions (FAQ)

1. How can I register for the course?

You can register via [the Moodle page of the course](#).

2. If I register, is my place guaranteed?

Unfortunately, no. There are more interested students than available places, and the final group will be selected by lottery.

3. How can be exempt from the lottery?

The only way is to **invoke the hardship clause**. [Section 90 of the ZSP-HU](#) defines a hardship case as follows:

> “Exceptional hardship can only exist if special reasons—especially health-related, social, disability-related or family-related—relating to the student’s personal circumstances absolutely require immediate participation in the course.”

> „Eine außergewöhnliche Härte kann nur vorliegen, wenn besondere, vor allem gesundheitliche, soziale, behinderungsbedingte oder familiäre, Gründe in der Person der Studentin oder des Studenten die sofortige Teilnahme an der Lehrveranstaltung zwingend erfordern.“

To request an exemption, please contact the **course lead** with **documentary evidence** of the hardship. The course lead will review the documentation and decide whether you may be **admitted without participating in the lottery**.

4. Is a medical certificate sufficient for an exemption from the lottery?

Yes. Genuine medical certificates (or certificates from qualified professionals or equivalent in case of different types of hardships) are acceptable evidence of hardship.

5. I did not pass the exam in a previous edition. Can I be exempt from the lottery?

Unfortunately not. Not passing the exam does not qualify as a hardship.

6. I had difficulties registering in previous editions and tried many times. Can I be exempt from the lottery?

Unfortunately not. Repeated unsuccessful registration attempts do not qualify as a hardship.

7. I need this course for my thesis. Can I be exempt from the lottery?

Unfortunately not. Needing the course for a thesis does not qualify as a hardship.

Use of Course Materials

All materials that I, Katarzyna Reluga, share (slides, videos/recordings, captions/transcripts, handouts, code, and any derivative works) are provided solely for your **personal study** as enrolled students in this course. You may view and download them for your own use. **You may not share, upload, repost, distribute, modify, or make them publicly available** (including via cloud drives, group chats, or social media) **without my prior written permission**. By participating in this course, you agree to these terms.